Was it as easy to understand as looking at its drawing?

I suppose that we can agree that there is fundamental value in drawing graphs, at least when we are supposed to understand and manually process them: although this is not always the case[4], there are many examples where we do want to visualize graphs, for instance in flow charts, UML diagrams, PERT charts and so on.

The next thing we need to agree (or not) upon is that not all visualizations are equally useful: take a look at figure 15.3, and compare it to figure 15.2. I don't know about you, but rather than using the diagram in figure 15.3, I might as well look at the definition of the graph, that's how confusing it feels.

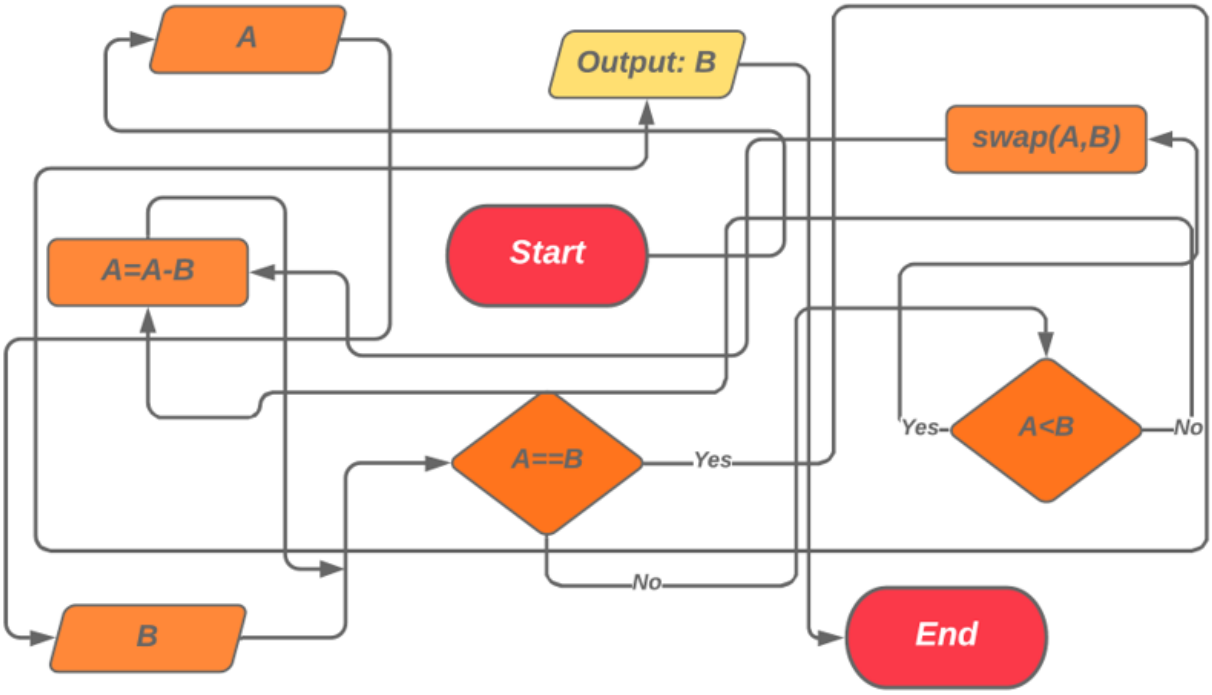


Figure 15.3 The same flow chart as in figure 15.2, just with a different layout. Can you still make sense of it?